Faceless48 Handoff: Export Spec (v1)

For whoever builds the export buttons in the Script, Shorts and Thumbnail engines. The Creator plug-in (beta.7) builds the matching importer. Plain text and one small image only. No media is exported except the thumbnail.

1. The package

One file named **<slug>.f48handoff.zip** (a plain folder with the same contents is also accepted). Inside: `handoff.json` (required, UTF-8), `thumbnail.png` (optional; PNG, JPG or WebP, 5 MB max) and `script.txt` (optional, a readable copy of the script). Unknown fields are ignored. Total size under 10 MB. Each engine can export on its own; a member who uses all three exports one combined package, and a later export of the same slug replaces the earlier one.

2. handoff.json fields

Field	Type	Required	What it holds
handoffVersion	integer	Yes	Always 1. The plug-in refuses a higher major number with a plain message.
createdAt	ISO date	Yes	When the member exported.
source	object	Yes	{"app":"faceless48-studio","engines":["script","shorts","thumbnail"]}: only the engines that contributed.
title	string	Yes	Working title of the video (200 characters max).
type	enum	Yes	One of: talking-head, yap, explainer, faceless, life-scene (see section 3). The member chooses it in the engine at export.
format	enum	No	portrait or landscape. Default portrait. Shorts are always portrait.
script.text	string	Script engine	The full script as plain text, no HTML or markdown.
script.sections[]	array	Script engine	In order: {id, heading, text}. Section breaks as the engine defines them. Ids unique ("s1", "s2"). Optional per section: message (one line the section is saying; used by life-scene), visual (a short note on what to show).
shorts[]	array	Shorts engine	Each: {id, title, text, fromSections[], approxSeconds}. fromSections must be ids that exist in script.sections when that is also exported. Each short is a separate video the plug-in can start.
thumbnail	object	Thumbnail engine	{file:"thumbnail.png", headline, alt}. The file name must match the file in the package.
stock.terms[]	array	No	Optional hints: {sectionId, terms[]}, 2 to 4 concrete words each. If missing, the plug-in derives its own from the script.
notes	string	No	Anything the member typed that the video maker should know (1000 characters max).

3. What each video type needs

type	Package must have	Member gives the plug-in (not in the package)	How the plug-in uses it
talking-head	title, type. Script and shorts recommended.	Raw video clip. The audio is already in it. No voiceover needed.	Script is the transcript check. Cutaways, captions, effects and stock B-roll are planned from it.
yap	title, type. Script optional.	Raw video clip with its own audio. No voiceover.	Captions and a light edit only. Script, if present, is the transcript check.
explainer (animated)	title, type, script with sections.	A voiceover audio file (mp3, wav or m4a). The plug-in does not create voiceovers.	Sections become scenes. The recording sets the timing, not the script.
faceless	title, type, script with sections.	A voiceover audio file, plus visuals: the member's own images or clips, or stock chosen from the options the plug-in shows (section 4).	Sections become scenes with images, footage or stock. The recording sets the timing.
life-scene	title, type, script sections with message lines (or a shorts list).	Clips: their own, AI-generated, or stock they choose. A voiceover is optional.	Each message becomes on-screen text of about 22 characters per line. The plug-in proposes the lines and the member approves them first.

The engine should tell the member this at export, in plain words: "Next, bring your voiceover" (explainer, faceless) or "Next, bring your raw clip" (talking-head, yap) or "Next, bring your clips" (life-scene).

4. Stock footage (handled by the plug-in, nothing for the engines to build)

After import, the plug-in searches Pexels and Pixabay for each section, using `stock.terms` or terms it derives from the script. It shows the member preview images, length, creator and links for the options. The member picks the clips they like and the plug-in downloads only those. The member never has to search or download by hand. A one-time setup of their own free Pexels and Pixabay keys is the only manual step, and the plug-in guides them through it. Credits are saved for the member's captions.

5. Validation the exporter must pass

Valid JSON; required fields present; type is one of the five values; section ids unique and non-empty; every shorts.fromSections id exists; every section has text; thumbnail.file exists in the package; all text is plain UTF-8 with no HTML. On failure the engine shows the member a plain message and does not create the package. The plug-in repeats these checks on import and names the exact field that is wrong.

6. Example (faceless, all three engines)

```
{ "handoffVersion": 1, "createdAt": "2026-11-02T14:05:00Z",
  "source": { "app": "faceless48-studio", "engines": ["script","shorts","thumbnail"] },
  "title": "Why your first video feels hard", "type": "faceless", "format": "landscape",
  "script": { "text": "Most people quit before ...",
    "sections": [ { "id": "s1", "heading": "The hook", "text": "Most people quit before ...", "visual": "someone staring at a blank screen" },
                  { "id": "s2", "heading": "The fix", "text": "Start with one clip ..." } ] },
  "shorts": [ { "id": "sh1", "title": "The quit point", "text": "Most people quit before ...", "fromSections": ["s1"], "approxSeconds": 30 } ],
  "thumbnail": { "file": "thumbnail.png", "headline": "Why it feels hard", "alt": "Blank screen and a cup of coffee" },
  "stock": { "terms": [ { "sectionId": "s1", "terms": ["blank laptop screen night"] } ] } }
```